Design Championship Project Synopsis

Project Title: Seekho Sikhao — Indian Students Teaching Indian Students

Theme: Safe peer learning for school students

Project Type: Individual

Category: Web Design, Senior (14–16)

Round: National round (updated version)

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School students already teach each other, a classmate who knows Python, a senior who wants to learn trigonometry, a cousin who does mehendi before annual day. That knowledge usually stays inside one friend circle or one campus club.

Paid tuition platforms treat the same need as a marketplace. They push one-to-one video calls with people the student does not know. For a school-age learner that is unlike how peer learning actually happens and difficult for a parent to supervise.

Seekho Sikhao addresses this gap. It is a group class board for Indian school students. Students register with parent consent, share short knowledge notes, and join or launch a skill batch. Google Meet stays locked until eight students have joined. There are no fees. When a batch ends, mentor and student both receive an e-certificate.

For the national round the idea and the four rules stay the same. I added a few things on top of them: Class requests, a skill promise, a note about school hours, a padlock animation, a For schools page and Hindi and Telugu screens. They are listed under What Changed for the National Round.

Theme Analysis

The theme is safe peer learning for school students. I read it as three separate ideas and checked every decision against each one.

Peer. The teacher is another student, a class or two ahead, unpaid, teaching something they picked up themselves. So there are no prices, no star ratings and no premium mentor badge.

Safe. The learners are in Class 6 to 12, so safety cannot sit in a terms page that nobody reads. It is in the layout: groups only, Meet locked until eight names, parent consent on the same form, and no private chat anywhere on the site.

Learning. A class needs a start, a finish and a record. The mentor says in advance what students will be able to do, and when the batch is done both sides get a numbered certificate.

I left some things out on purpose: one-to-one calls, payments, direct messages, ads and public rankings of mentors. Each would make the site easier to grow, and each would break one of the three words.

What Problem Does It Solve?

Students who want to teach or learn a skill after school have no safe, free, group-first place to do it.

Existing options fail in three ways:

- Private tuition apps and random video calls are one-to-one with strangers.
- School clubs exist, but they are tied to one campus and one timetable.
- Social media can spread a trick, but it does not form a class, keep a parent in the loop, or give a record when the work is finished.

Seekho Sikhao solves all three problems:

1. Group class, not a private chat — Meet opens only after eight names.
2. Parent consent on the same form — no join or launch without a guardian tick.
3. A finish line — dual e-certificates and an experiences page when the batch is marked done.

Students have skills to share, but no supervised batch in which to share them.

One more gap showed up after the regional round. A mentor can launch a batch and wait with an empty list, and a student who wants a class that nobody teaches has no way to ask for it.

Target Users

- **Student learner (Class 6–12)** — needs a real class, not a chat with one stranger. Joins a batch, or asks for one. Meet unlocks after eight names.
- **Student mentor (Class 8–12)** — needs a way to teach without looking like a paid tutor. Launches a batch and writes a skill promise. Receives a mentor certificate when it closes.
- **Parent / guardian** — needs to know the call is a group and that consent was given. Ticks the box on the register form. May sit in Meet. Can print a one-page parent sheet.
- **Next batch of students** — needs proof that a mentor finished a class. Reads experiences and printable certificates.
- **Teacher or club in-charge** — wants the same lock for a school batch. Pastes the school's own Meet link in place of the sample code.

Primary user: a Class 9–11 student in an Indian city who already uses Google Meet for school.

Core Design Principle

Seekho Sikhao is built on the principle of a courtyard class, moved onto Google Meet. It offers peer teaching while leaving supervision and consent with a parent, and leaving the Meet link locked until the group is large enough to be a class.

The design focuses on:

- Group-first learning — never one-to-one private calls.
- Visitor actions stored only on this device — no company server, no paid account.
- Visible safety — locked Meet card, consent panel, mentor promise, house rules on the How page.
- Indian skill set as first-class content — tech, art, music, dance, languages, STEM, sports, life skills.
- Ask first, teach second — a class can start from eight students asking for it.

Proposed Solution

Seekho Sikhao is a client-side web application. Four product rules do the real design work:

- **Minimum 8 students before Google Meet opens.** Makes it a class, not a private tuition. The Meet code stays hidden until the count is reached.
- **Parent / guardian consent on the same form.** A diary-note home, not a terms-of-service wall. Without the tick, join and launch stay closed.
- **No fees anywhere.** Removes pressure and the fake premium-mentor path.
- **Certificate for both sides when the mentor marks done.** Teaching is work. Learning is work. Both get a paper.

A fifth loop sits on top of classes: the Knowledge wall. Short notes collect likes. Likes grow followers. At 100 followers a longer Blog unlocks. The blog is earned by teaching, not purchased as a badge.

For the national round three parts were added on top of these rules: Class requests, a skill promise on every batch, and a For schools page. The table below lists these and the smaller changes.

What Changed for the National Round

Addition	Why it was added
Class requests (#/requests)	A mentor can launch a batch and wait with an empty list, and a learner had no way to ask for a class that nobody teaches. A student asks, others tap Me too, and at eight voices a mentor can take the request with the eight already on the list.
Skill promise	"I will teach Python" tells a joiner very little. Before launching, the mentor answers three questions: what students will be able to do, what will not be taught, and how long each class is. The answers show on the batch card.
Padlock and ring	The locked Meet card now shows a ring that counts toward eight. When the eighth student joins, the padlock opens and the card flips to show the code.
School-time note	The launch form asks for a day and a time. A weekday class between 8 a.m. and 3 p.m. gets a soft note to pick an evening or weekend. It never blocks the launch.
For schools (#/schools)	A teacher pastes the school's own Meet link in place of the sample code. Same lock, same parent tick, same eight. There is a small demo on the page.
Hindi and Telugu	A parent may be more comfortable in Hindi or Telugu than in English. Buttons in the header switch the main screens.
Parent sheet (#/parent/:id)	One printable page for a parent: mentor, schedule, promise, rules and consent.
Smaller fixes	Mentor promise ticks on Launch, leave a batch, report a problem, WhatsApp invite, batch search. Certificates are now written for every student, with a seal and a signature line. Skip link and reduced-motion support.

One idea I dropped: an Investors tab was suggested during mentoring. I left it out because the project is free by its own rule, and a funding page moves attention from the students to a business plan. The For schools page keeps the idea of growth inside the original concept.

Working Principle

Simple path through the site:

1. The student opens Home and reads the three rules: eight names, parent consent, no fees.
2. Register splits into a student block and a parent / guardian consent block. Without the tick, batches stay closed.
3. The student joins a forming batch, launches one, or asks for a class on the Requests page. A mentor answers the three skill-promise questions first, and sees a soft note if the class falls in school hours.
4. Until eight names are on the list, the Meet card shows a padlock and a ring that counts. At eight the ring completes, the padlock opens and the Meet code appears. The same link is used every week. Parents may sit in.
5. Short notes go on the Knowledge wall. Likes grow followers. At 100 followers the Blog page opens.
6. When the mentor marks the batch done, mentor and every student receive an e-certificate that can be printed.

Special feature: Demo entry as Aditya or Ananya. A judge can open a full adda without typing a fake parent name. On a batch launched in the demo, a button adds eight sample students so the padlock can be seen opening. Reset demo clears this browser.

Everything runs in one HTML file in the browser. No React. No CMS. No website builder. No company login server.

Information Architecture

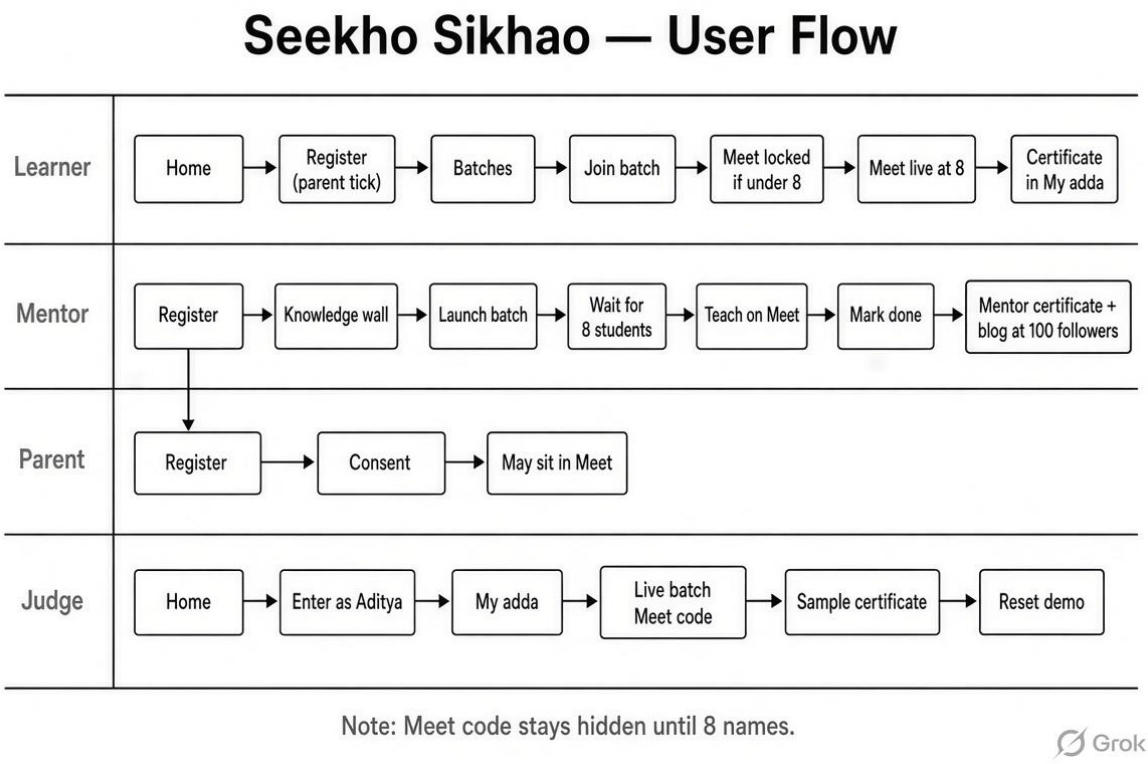
Sitemap

The site is a hash-router single page. Every screen is a function that returns HTML into #app. The language buttons sit in the header on every page.

Route	Page	Job
#/	Home	Promise, three doors, ask-for-a-class banner, categories, live batches, sample certificate
#/batches	Batches board	Search, and filter by status (forming / live / done) and subject
#/batch/:id	Batch detail	Mentor, skill promise, roster, locked or live Meet, join / leave / close, invite, report
#/launch	Launch batch	Mentor form — title, skill, city, skill promise, day and time, mentor promise
#/requests	Class requests	Ask for a class, Me too, Take this class
#/register	Register	Student block + parent consent. Demo as Ananya / Aditya
#/knowledge	Knowledge wall	Subject filter, notes, like, upload a note
#/blogs	Blogs	Longer notes. Write form appears only at 100 followers
#/experiences	Experiences	After-class voices from mentor and student
#/certificate/:id	E-certificate	Printable mentor or student copy
#/parent/:id	Parent sheet	One printable page for a parent
#/schools	For schools	Same lock with a school's own Meet link (small demo)

Route	Page	Job
#/adda	My adda	Stats, batches, certificates, reset demo
#/people/:id	Profile	Bio, follow, their batches and notes
#/how and #/about	How / About	Steps, house rules, demo-character notice

User Flow



This diagram is from the regional round. The request and school flows are written out below.

Learner: Home → Register (parent ticks consent) → Batches → Join. Under eight names the Meet card only shows the count. At eight the code appears. When the mentor marks the batch done, the student certificate shows in My adda.

Mentor: Register → Knowledge wall → Launch a batch (skill promise, mentor promise) → wait for eight → teach on the same Meet link → Mark done. Mentor certificate follows. At 100 followers the Blog page opens.

Requester: Register → Requests → ask for a class, or tap Me too on one that is there → at eight voices the card says Mentor wanted → a mentor taps Take this class → the Launch form opens with the eight students already listed.

Parent: Same Register page. Consent is on that screen. The batch page states that a parent may sit in Meet.

School: For schools → paste a Meet link → move the student slider → locked under eight, open at eight with the school's own link.

Judge / demo: Home → Enter as Aditya → My adda → open a live batch and show the Meet code → Requests: Spoken Telugu is at 7 of 8, tap Me too → launch a batch and add eight sample students → switch to Telugu → open a sample certificate → Reset demo.

Content Model

Hard-coded seed data paints the courtyard so the first open is not an empty board. Visitor actions are stored in local storage under the key seekho-html-v1.

- CATS / SKILLS / CITIES / CLASSES — taxonomy, seed in code
- PEOPLE — 14 written student characters, seed in code
- BATCHES — 9 batches in three states, seed plus user launches. PROMISE_SEED holds a skill promise for each of the nine
- WISHES — 5 seed class requests in different states (one at 7 of 8 voices, one waiting for a mentor, one already taken)
- I18N — one dictionary of interface text in English, Hindi and Telugu
- POSTS / BLOGS / EXPS / CERTS — wall, notebooks, voices, papers
- S.me, joined, liked, followed, wishes, supported, lang — visitor adda, runtime in this browser

Design Decisions

Visual system

Most education sites use purple gradients and stock photos of laptops. That does not match a courtyard class. Seekho Sikhao uses a warm paper ground, saffron for action, peacock green for navigation, and a thin tricolour bar. Type is split: serif titles, simple sans for buttons, Devanagari on the wordmark. The faint octagon tile in the background is a jaali.

Interaction

Sticky header with the same links on every page. There are eight now, so below 1280px the links go behind a menu button, and the language buttons move into it on a phone. Status is a pill with words: Forming, Meet live, Completed. Cards lift on hover. Tap targets are at least 44px because the site will be used on a phone after school.

Safety as layout

The Meet block on a batch page has two designs. Under eight students it is a locked card with a padlock and a ring that counts. At eight the ring completes, the padlock opens and the card flips to reveal the code and an Open Google Meet button. That visual change is the product. The animation plays once and is switched off for anyone who has asked their device for reduced motion. Registration puts parent consent in a nested panel. How it works lists house rules: no fees, no UPI, no one-to-one, parents may sit in.

The skill promise sits above the Meet card, so what students will learn is as visible as the rule about when Meet opens. A very short first answer is refused, so "Python" alone cannot launch a batch. Asking what the mentor will not teach stops a Class 10 student from promising too much. The school-time note is advice only. School hours differ and some students have afternoon shifts, so the mentor makes the final choice.

Language

A small dictionary holds each line of interface text in English, Hindi and Telugu. A function looks up the chosen language and falls back to English if a line is missing. The choice is remembered in the browser. Noto Sans Devanagari and Noto Sans Telugu are loaded for the new scripts, and letter-spacing is turned off for them because it broke the joined letters in my first try. Translated so far: the menu, buttons, status words, Home headline, Meet messages, safety lines, footer, the Class requests page, the Launch form and the batch cards.

Voice

Copy is written like a student notice, not a brochure. Eight is the rule. A diary note for home. Print it for the cupboard. Character bios stay specific (kolam with a grandmother, tabla on a terrace). Profiles on the board are written characters, and the About page states so.

Accessibility

Keyboard users get a visible outline on buttons and links, and a Skip to content link. Controls are at least 44px tall for phone use. Status pills say Forming, Meet live or Completed in words, not only in colour. The progress ring and the request bars carry text labels. Avatars carry a name, and the certificate page hides extra buttons when printing.

UI Concepts

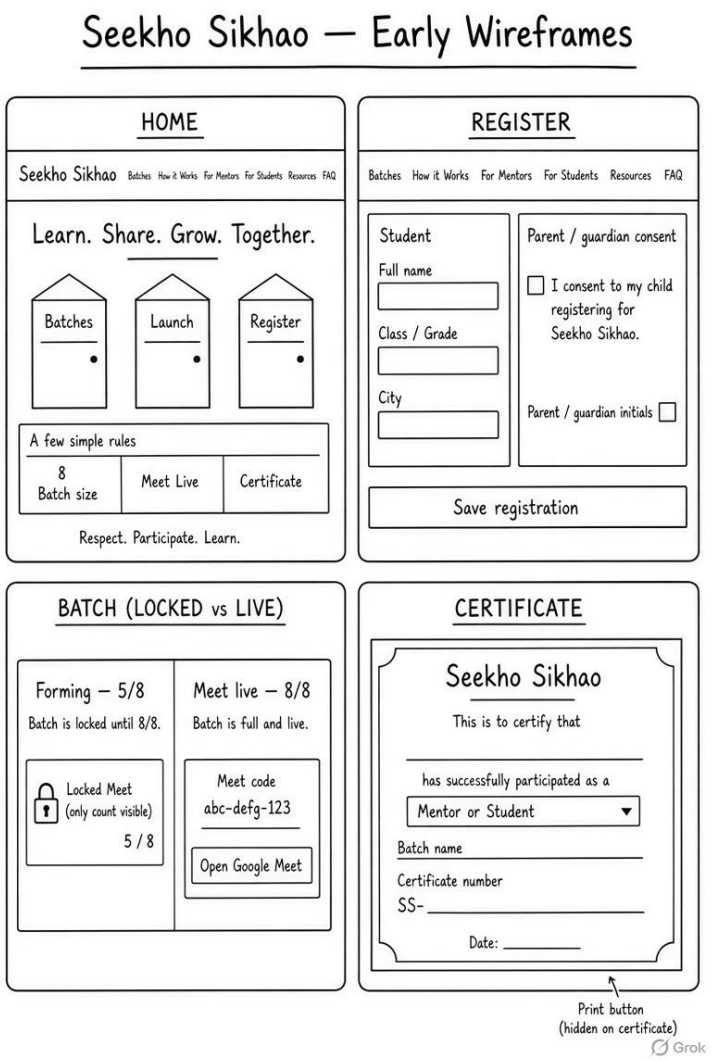
- Background: warm paper
- Action colour: saffron; trust / links: peacock green
- Type: serif titles, sans interface, Devanagari wordmark
- Cards: rounded, light shadow, lift on hover
- Avatars: SVG motifs from a colour hue — no photographs of real students
- Certificate: full print page with a number, a seal and a signature line, not a popup message
- Meet card: padlock and a ring that counts to eight, then a flip to the code
- Request card: progress bar, status pill, avatars of the students who asked

Design Iterations

Version	Attempt	Outcome
Sketch 1	Marketplace of 1:1 tutors with prices	Dropped. Unsafe and against the idea.
Sketch 2	Open chat room by subject	Dropped. No batch, no parent, no end.
Sketch 3	School club pages with long forms	Too heavy. Students would bounce.
Build 1	Separate HTML files per page	Dropped. One-file hash pages are easier to submit.
Build 2	Meet link always visible	Changed. Link now locked until 8.
Build 3	Followers only from a Follow button	Added likes-on-notes so teaching on the wall also counts.
Build 4	Certificate as a popup	Changed to a full printable page with a number.
Polish	Purple ed-tech palette	Replaced with paper, saffron, peacock.
Build 5	Locked Meet shown as a line of text	Replaced with a padlock and a ring, then the unlock animation.
Build 6	One-line description from the mentor	Added the three-question skill promise.
Build 7	Only mentors could start something	Added Class requests so learners can ask first.
Build 8	Investors tab, suggested in mentoring	Dropped. The project is free by rule. Replaced with a For schools page.
Build 9	English only	Hindi and Telugu added for the main screens.

Early notebook wireframes covered four screens: home with three doors (Batches, Launch, Register); a batch card with Meet locked and the same card with the code visible; a register form split into student half and parent half; a certificate laid out like a school prize paper. The built site

follows those four pages. The new pages reuse the same cards and pills, so I did not draw new wireframes.



Wireframes

Four notebook screens guided the build:

1. Home — three doors: Batches, Launch, Register.
2. Register — student half and parent-consent half on one page.
3. Batch — Meet locked under eight names; Meet code visible at eight.
4. Certificate — a print page, not a popup.

The live site follows these four screens.

Technical Approach

Stack: one HTML file, CSS in a style block, behaviour in a script block. No React, no build step, no CMS. Hosting is optional because the app is static. A folder copy (index.html, style.css, app.js and a README) is also included.

Limits of the prototype

There is no real school login server. Meet codes in the demo are sample codes, and the lock works in the browser, so anyone reading the page source could see a sample code. A real version would keep the code on a server until eight students join. Parent phone numbers stay in this browser only. Board profiles and the students on the request cards are written characters, and the About page says so. A school club version would paste a teacher-made Meet link, which the For schools demo shows but does not save. Only part of the site is translated, and the Hindi and Telugu wording was drafted with AI help, so it is the part that most needs a check by a fluent reader. Users are under 18, so a real version would also need verified parental consent, as India's data protection law asks for children's data.

Architecture

- Seed data — categories, people, batches, skill promises, requests, posts, translations at the top of the file.
- State S — the visitor. Loaded from localStorage or an empty adda.
- Helpers — save, toast, esc (stops HTML injection in names and notes), person, avatar, t (translation), liveBatches, liveWishes.
- Page functions — each route returns an HTML string.
- window actions — joinBatch, leaveBatch, completeBatch, likePost, follow, registerMe, launch, addPost, addWish, supportWish, takeWish, setLang, reportBatch.
- render() — reads location.hash, paints nav and language buttons, writes innerHTML of #app, sets the page title and language.

Key function: liveBatches()

Seed batches and user-launched batches are merged. Joins from this browser are added to the student list if there is room and the visitor is not already the mentor. Status is then recomputed: if marked complete, it is completed; else if seats are 8 or more, it is running. Every card on Home and Batches reads this live list, so the board updates without a server.

Key function: liveWishes()

Seed requests and the visitor's own are merged, and the visitor's name is added to a request they tapped Me too on. A request is Gathering under eight voters, Mentor wanted at eight or more, and Taken once a batch is made from it. Taking a request opens the Launch form with the request's id in the address, and launch() copies the voters into the new batch's student list, so the batch starts with eight names.

Other new functions

meetCard() draws the Meet card in one of three states: locked with the ring, just unlocked, or open. joinBatch() sets a flag when the seat count becomes exactly eight, and the next render of that page reads and clears it, so the animation plays once and not on every refresh. inSchoolHours() returns true when the day is Monday to Friday, the class starts before 3 p.m. and ends after 8 a.m. The launch form calls it whenever the day, time or class length changes, and only shows or clears the note.

Implementation notes

- esc() encodes special characters before any user text is dropped into HTML.
- trySample fills a legal demo adda so a review is not forced to type a fake parent name.
- completeBatch refuses if seats are under 8 or the visitor is not the mentor, then writes a mentor certificate, one certificate for each student, and adds 15 followers.

- addPost adds 4 followers so 100 is reachable in a demo without being free.
- launch() refuses a very short skill promise and needs all three mentor ticks.
- The For schools demo accepts only a link shaped like https://meet.google.com/abc-defg-hij, so a pasted script link can never become a button.
- Avatars are inline SVG motifs hashed from a hue. No stock photos.
- Fonts: Fraunces, Nunito Sans, Tiro Devanagari Hindi, Noto Sans Devanagari, Noto Sans Telugu (Open Font License). Offline fallback: Georgia / Segoe UI.

Testing. Every route was opened in English, Hindi and Telugu. The launch form was tried with weekday and weekend times, a short promise and a request taken from the board. The unlock animation was checked with reduced motion on and off.

External Assets and Attribution

- Google Fonts — Fraunces, Nunito Sans, Tiro Devanagari Hindi, Noto Sans Devanagari, Noto Sans Telugu. Open Font License.
- Google Meet and WhatsApp — outbound buttons only. Sample codes in the demo.
- Inline SVG logo, avatars, padlock, ring and certificate seal — drawn in code for this project.
- The user-flow and wireframe images in this document were generated with Grok (see AI Usage Disclosure).
- No stock photos, no icon pack, no CSS framework, no CMS theme.

AI Usage Disclosure

The championship allows AI tools for research, UI suggestions, debugging help and documentation. Seekho Sikhao was not generated as a finished website and pasted.

Student-owned core: the four safety rules, the page map, the data shapes, the routing design, the seed world (people, batches, posts), and the visual system. For the national round I also chose which features to add and which to drop.

AI tool used	Purpose of use	Output generated	Student contribution or modification
Grok (xAI)	Wording, debug talk, accessibility checklist, the regional synopsis, the user-flow and wireframe images	Shorter labels, hash-routing notes, first draft of the synopsis, two diagram images	Rules, page map, seed data and liveBatches() written and tested in the HTML. Drafts checked against index.html before they stayed.
ChatGPT	Early list / layout structure	Sample arrays and page blocks	Lists rewritten for Indian cities and school skills (Python, rangoli, tabla, cricket).
GitHub Copilot	First sketch of join actions	Suggested function layout	joinBatch rewritten and tested so names join the list without breaking the page.
Claude (Anthropic)	Code help for the national-round additions (requests, skill promise, unlock animation, school-time note, For schools, parent sheet, Hindi and Telugu), test runs, and this updated synopsis	Code added to index.html, page-by-page test runs, draft text for this document	Chose which features go in and which stay out (Investors tab dropped). Each follows my rules: eight, parent consent, no fees, group only. Checked the result against the site.

Not used: one-prompt auto-building of the whole site; a website builder; a CMS theme.

How the Project Meets Judging Criteria

Design thinking and problem solving. Group-first model vs tuition apps. Parent consent as a screen, not a PDF. Meet lock as the mechanic that enforces the idea. Class requests answers the empty-batch problem.

UI and UX. Paper courtyard visual system. Sticky nav. Status pills. 44px targets. Certificate print view. Demo-login so a judge is not blocked by a form. A padlock and ring that make the rule visible, and three languages for the main screens.

Technical quality. Working SPA: register, join, leave, launch with a skill promise, ask for a class, take a class, like, follow, close batch with certificates for everyone, persist in localStorage, escape user text, responsive nav.

Innovation and uniqueness. Eight-before-Meet. Dual certificates. Follower-gated blog. Indian skill set as first-class categories. Eight voices make a class. A skill promise that also says what will not be taught.

Presentation and understanding. This document, the 30 to 60 second video, and a walkthrough of liveBatches(), liveWishes() and the Meet lock.

Project Demonstration Notes

Website purpose. A group class board for Indian school students. Teach a batch, join a batch, or ask for one. Not one-to-one.

Key features. Parent consent, 8-before-Meet, knowledge wall, 100-follower blog, dual e-certificate, demo adda, Class requests, skill promise, padlock animation, school-time note, For schools, Hindi and Telugu.

User journey. Sneha joining Compound cricket, a new mentor launching a Python batch and waiting for eight, or a learner asking for Spoken Telugu, which is at 7 of 8 voices, and tapping Me too.

Design decisions. Paper, saffron and peacock so the site feels like a school magazine. Locked Meet card so the rule is visible. Advice, not blocking, for school hours.

Code structure. Seed data at the top, state S in localStorage, page functions, render() on hashchange, one dictionary for the three languages.

AI usage. Grok tightened copy and the regional document. Claude helped with the national-round code and this document. The rules and the batch logic were student decisions.

Challenges. Merging seed batches with joined lists without double-counting the mentor. Keeping Meet hidden until eight. Making the unlock animation play once. Keeping Hindi and Telugu letters joined.

Skills developed. Information architecture, client-side state, accessible UI, interface copy, working in three scripts, knowing when a prototype should stop claiming things.

Development workflow. Paper sitemap to colour tokens to seed world to router to actions to CSS polish to documentation. For the national round: add one feature at a time, open every route in all three languages, then update the documents.

Conclusion

Seekho Sikhao responds to a clear gap — students have skills, but no supervised batch — with a practical web application: parent consent, eight names before Meet, a knowledge wall, a blog earned at 100 followers, and an e-certificate for both sides. The national-round version adds a way to ask for a class, a skill promise, a note about school hours, a For schools page and Hindi and Telugu screens, all inside the same rules.

Built as one original HTML file, designed for an Indian school courtyard rather than an app-store landing page, and free for the student, it fills a space that tuition marketplaces and empty social feeds ignore.

The prototype is honest about its limits (sample Meet codes, browser-only storage, written characters on the board, partly translated screens) and complete about its rules. Those rules are the project.